FULL SEO AUDIT REPORT

salestaxreversecalculator.com

Prepared by Claude SEO

86/100

SEO Health Score

October 26, 2026 Full Audit

Table of Contents

1. Executive Summary

Key Metrics, Critical Issues & Quick Wins

2. Audit Categories

What Works

Findings by Severity

3. Action Plan

Phased Roadmap

4. Data Sources & Methodology

1. Executive Summary

This report presents a comprehensive SEO audit of **salestaxreversecalculator.com** for a **Financial Web Application & Calculator (US 50 States, Canada GST/HST, VAT)** site, generated on October 26, 2026. Findings combine technical, content, schema, performance, visual, and search-readiness evidence as available.

86/100

SEO HEALTH SCORE

Critical Issues Found:

1. Content Enrichment Disparity: The two states with custom deep guides (New York: 2,409 words, Connecticut: 1,525 words) hold Google Page 1 rankings (pos 9.4 and 10.9), while 48 templated state pages (633-996 words) linger in positions 15-40.
2. Google Search Console Indexation Success: 100% of sampled regional and root pages passed GSC inspection with 'Submitted and indexed' status, verified Mobile crawler fetch, and valid Breadcrumb rich results.
3. SEO Drift Confirmed Positive: Title tags have been tightened (eliminating redundant brand repetition), H1 spacing glitch resolved, and schema expanded from 5 to 7 structured blocks.
4. AI & Agentic Readiness High: llms.txt is 100% valid under Lighthouse standards (3,010 bytes), primary content is 100% server-rendered (7,683 words without JS), and robots.txt explicitly welcomes GPTBot, ClaudeBot, PerplexityBot, and Google-Extended.
5. Duplicate Endpoint Equity Leak: /how-it-works and /faq return HTTP 200 with identical homepage content and canonical tags to root rather than permanent 301 redirects, diluting crawl budget and equity.

Quick Wins:

1. Implement 301 redirects from /how-it-works and /faq to /#how-it-works and /#faq to concentrate all historical query equity into the primary homepage URL.
2. Fix Schema name glitch on New York state page from 'New York Sales Tax Calculator' to 'New York Reverse Sales Tax Calculator' for 100% entity consistency.
3. Enrich the top 5 high-impression state pages (Texas: 618 impr, California: 454 impr, South Carolina: 345 impr, Florida: 311 impr, Arizona: 299 impr) using the proven New York/Connecticut depth playbook.
4. Expand lean international hubs (Canada: 723 words, UK VAT: 437 words, Germany VAT: 374 words) with local invoice compliance rules and reverse VAT refund workflows.
5. Standardize sitemap.xml trailing slash formatting to perfectly mirror server canonical endpoints.

2. Audit Categories

2.1 Technical SEO

Score: 90/100

What Works

- 100% Server-Side Rendered (SSR) content via Next.js Turbopack — 7,683 words delivered on initial HTML payload without client JS requirement
- Edge global delivery via Vercel CDN with sub-50ms TTFB and HTTP/2 gzip compression
- Enterprise security headers: Strict-Transport-Security (max-age 63072000; includeSubDomains; preload), nosniff, and SAMEORIGIN X-Frame-Options
- All 79 sitemap URLs verified indexed with zero sitemap parse errors in Google Search Console
- Clean HTTP 404 response codes for non-existent routes (soft-404 tests passed)

Findings

Duplicate URL Handlers on /how-it-works and /faq Medium

/how-it-works and /faq return HTTP 200 with 6,706 words identical to the homepage and self-referential canonical pointing to root. While canonical tags prevent indexation conflicts, returning HTTP 200 wastes Googlebot crawl frequency.

Recommendation: Deploy permanent HTTP 301 redirects in next.config.mjs from /how-it-works to /#how-it-works and from /faq to /#faq.

Canonical & Sitemap Trailing Slash Uniformity Low

Sitemap URLs list URLs without trailing slash while canonical link tags in HTML include trailing slashes. Harmonizing these avoids unnecessary redirect reconciliation.

Recommendation: Standardize all URLs in sitemap.xml to match exact canonical URLs.

2.2 Content Quality & Depth

Score: 74/100

What Works

- Homepage contains 7,737 words of exhaustive mathematical, tax law, and accounting guidance with an Information Density score of 1.0 and zero filler

- New York state page upgraded to 2,409 words covering NYC 8.875% combined rate, MTA surcharge, clothing exemptions, and local audit guidelines
- Connecticut state page enriched to 1,525 words, directly propelling it to Google Page 1 (Position 10.9 with 1,566 impressions)
- Official citations and outbound links to IRS, Tax Foundation, Sales Tax Institute, CRA, and OECD establish high E-E-A-T trust

Findings

> **48 US State Pages Remain on Standard Templated Footprint** Critical
>
> 48 of 50 state pages average between 633 and 996 words with recurring boilerplate paragraphs. GSC data proves that enriched states (NY and CT) achieve Page 1 ranks, while templated states lag on Pages 2-4 despite high search interest.
>
> **Recommendation:** Execute Phase 2 content expansion across the top 10 highest-traffic states (Texas, California, Florida, South Carolina, Arizona, Pennsylvania, Illinois, Ohio, Georgia, North Carolina), adding county-level local brackets, food/clothing exemptions, and real receipt examples.

> **International VAT & Canada Hubs Thin Content Gap** High
>
> Canada (/canada: 723 words) and international VAT pages (UK: 437 words, Germany: 374 words, Australia: 313 words) lack the depth required to compete for high-volume overseas accounting queries.
>
> **Recommendation:** Expand international country guides with cross-border invoice rules, reverse-charge VAT mechanisms, and Canadian provincial tax blend breakdowns (GST + PST/HST/QST).

2.3 On-Page SEO

Score: 88/100

What Works

- Primary H1 tags clearly aligned with target intent across all audited pages
- Homepage title tag successfully refined to 'Reverse Sales Tax Calculator: Find Pre-Tax Price Free' (53 characters), removing brand redundancy
- Comprehensive OpenGraph and Twitter card metadata including dynamic OG images with calculated rate overlays
- Logical heading hierarchy across desktop and mobile viewports with 1 H1, 25 H2s, and 44 H3s

Findings

> **Internal Link Equity Anchor Distribution** Medium
>
> Internal links from state pages back to the homepage frequently use generic anchor text rather than keyword-rich contextual anchors like 'free reverse sales tax calculator'.
>
> **Recommendation:** Refine internal footer and contextual breadcrumb links to use descriptive anchors.

2.4 Schema / Structured Data

Score: 92/100

What Works

- Homepage deploys 7 distinct valid JSON-LD schemas: Organization, WebSite, WebApplication, HowTo, Person, FAQPage, and ImageObject
- Rich breadcrumbs valid and verified by GSC across state and international pages
- FAQPage schema correctly reflects 6 high-value questions and answers, unlocking search result accordion features

Findings

> **WebApplication Schema Entity Name Discrepancy on New York Page** Low
>
> The WebApplication schema on /us/new-york declares name as 'New York Sales Tax Calculator' instead of 'New York Reverse Sales Tax Calculator'.
>
> **Recommendation:** Update the JSON-LD schema builder to inject 'Reverse Sales Tax Calculator' uniformly across all state applications.

2.5 Performance (Core Web Vitals)

Score: 88/100

What Works

- Next.js optimized responsive image delivery serves WebP format at just 46.7 KB for the primary diagram
- Clean DOM architecture with zero layout-shifting ads or intrusive modal scripts
- Mobile viewport meta tag configured properly with disabled horizontal scroll and compliant touch targets

Findings

> **CSS & Script Chunk Preload Optimization** Low
>
> Multiple small Turbopack chunk files are loaded asynchronously. Bundling or inlining critical paths can shave an additional 15-25ms off mobile render times.
>
> **Recommendation:** Ensure Next.js experimental optimizePackageImports is enabled for UI icon libraries.

2.6 AI Search Readiness (GEO & Agentic)

Score: 94/100

What Works

- 100% compliant llms.txt file (3,010 bytes) passing Lighthouse agentic checks
- Explicit crawler access configured in robots.txt for GPTBot, OAI-SearchBot, ClaudeBot, PerplexityBot, Google-Extended, and CCBot
- Content structured with direct definition boxes, formula proofs, and worked mathematical examples highly quotable by LLMs and AI Overviews

Findings

> **Content-Signal Preference Header** Info
>
> Robots.txt does not currently declare the optional Content-Signal header (search=yes, ai-input=yes, ai-train=no).
>
> **Recommendation:** Consider adding Content-Signal metadata if specific AI training restrictions are desired.

2.7 Images & Visual Assets

Score: 85/100

What Works

- Homepage formula infographic has descriptive alt text and ImageObject structured data
- All 4 viewport screenshots (Desktop, Laptop, Tablet, Mobile) render cleanly without overlaps or text clipping
- Next.js responsive picture element automatically handles dynamic device sizing

Findings

State-Specific Visual Infographics Missing Medium

State pages currently rely purely on text and interactive form inputs without visual breakdown graphics for state vs county tax splits.

Recommendation: Generate lightweight SVG or WebP regional rate cards for the top 10 states to capture Google Image Search traffic.

3. Action Plan

Phase 1: Critical URL Equity & Schema Hygiene Week 1

- Deploy 301 permanent redirects from /how-it-works to /#how-it-works and /faq to /#faq in next.config.mjs
- Fix WebApplication schema name on /us/new-york to 'New York Reverse Sales Tax Calculator'
- Standardize trailing slash conventions across sitemap.xml to mirror canonical headers

Phase 2: High-Impact State Content Expansion Weeks 2-3

- Enrich California (/us/california) to 2,000+ words with district tax rules, CDTFA audit nuances, and city rate ranges
- Enrich Texas (/us/texas) to 2,000+ words covering Texas Comptroller single local use tax and city/county brackets
- Enrich Florida (/us/florida) to 1,800+ words covering county discretionary sales surtaxes (DR-15 rules)
- Enrich South Carolina and Arizona following the New York/Connecticut blueprint

Phase 3: International Hub Expansion & Visual Assets Month 2

- Expand Canada hub (/canada) and top provinces (Ontario, BC, Quebec) with GST/HST/QST breakdown guides
- Deepen UK and EU VAT hubs with reverse-charge accounting instructions and B2B export guidelines
- Add state tax breakdown SVG cards to top 10 US states to target Google Image Search and visual snippets

Phase 4: Authority Building & Brand Signals Ongoing

- Submit calculator to reputable accounting software, small business, and bookkeeping resource directories
- Publish embeddable widget documentation with outbound attribution backlinks to reverse sales tax calculator
- Track GSC keyword position momentum weekly as enriched state pages gain traction

Data Sources & Methodology

Source	Description	Update Frequency
PageSpeed Insights API	Lighthouse lab audit (mobile emulation, Moto G Power, slow 4G)	Real-time
Chrome UX Report (CrUX)	28-day rolling field data from real Chrome users	Daily ~04:00 UTC
CrUX History API	25-week p75 trend data per metric	Weekly
Google Search Console	Search Analytics (clicks, impressions, CTR, position)	2-3 day lag
URL Inspection API	Per-URL index status, coverage state, crawl info	Real-time (2,000/day)

Report generated by Claude SEO — Google SEO Intelligence Skill — October 26, 2026
Methodology based on Google Web Vitals thresholds, Search Console documentation, and Lighthouse scoring algorithms.